THE BABY SHOWER CHECKLIST

Show up for her, not just the gifts.

What actually helps before, during, and after the shower, whether you're hosting, co-hosting, or just showing up. Registry-smart, budget-friendly, and focused on her, not the spotlight.

THE DUDELA CO.
Turning Dudes Into Dads

BEFORE THE SHOWER

Your job starts before the party does.

The shower itself is a few hours. The prep work is where you actually matter: the registry, the budget, and the logistics that make the day easy on her instead of one more thing she's managing alone.

Registry & Planning

Build it together. Don't just approve whatever she sends you.

- [ ] **Sit down and build the registry together.** Not a five-minute rubber stamp on her list.
- [ ] **Include the big-ticket practical items.** Car seat, stroller, crib, not just the cute small stuff.
- [ ] **Set a household budget line** for whatever the registry doesn't cover.
- [ ] **Confirm the date and venue actually work for her.** Comfort near her due date beats a "perfect" venue.
- [ ] **If you're co-hosting, split real tasks.** Venue, invites, food, instead of vaguely "helping."

Budget-Smart Prep

The shower rarely covers everything. Plan for the gap now.

- [ ] **Track registry gaps** after RSVPs come in, not just what's left the week before.
- [ ] **Skip duplicate small stuff.** Prioritize what's actually needed over what's easy to buy.
- [ ] **Spend on what lasts, save on the rest.** Pay up for gear you'll use through several stages. Buy the small stuff cheap, and check gently-used for things like cribs.

> **Not sure what to put on the list?** Turn the page. That's our own registry: the gear we'd actually buy again.

DAD-APPROVED REGISTRY PICKS

What we'd actually buy again.

Babies need way less than the internet says. Our rule: spend money on things that last through more than one stage, and keep everything else simple.

Worth paying more for

1. **A Nuna stroller with the travel system.** The car seat clicks right into the stroller and it folds easily. You'll use it from the ride home from the hospital to the toddler years.
2. **A Babysense monitor.** Worth it for the peace of mind at 2am. Code **DudeLA10** takes 10% off.
3. **A Hatch sound machine, one for home and one for travel.** Baby gets the same sleep cues in the nursery and at grandma's.
4. **The Wildbird Aerial carrier.** The carrier we actually wore, over and over.
5. **The Lovevery Play Gym.** It grows with them for months instead of weeks, and their other toys hold up too.

Simple stuff you'll use every day

- [ ] **An Angelcare baby bath.** Makes those first slippery baths a lot less stressful.
- [ ] **One bottle brand, starter set first.** Babies are picky. Find the one yours takes before you stock up.
- [ ] **The Frida Baby safety gear.** Thermometer, **NoseFrida**, and the **nail trimmer**.
- [ ] **Two packs of muslin burp cloths.** Cheap, and always in use. You can't have too many.

> **Not a registry item, but maybe the best money you'll spend:** the **Taking Cara Babies** newborn class. Do it before baby comes, so you have a sleep plan before you're too tired to make one.

Full disclosure: we partner with Babysense and Taking Cara Babies, and some links above are affiliate links. If you buy through them, we may earn a small commission at no extra cost to you. We'd recommend all of it either way.

DURING THE SHOWER

Show up. Don't take over.

Whatever your role that day, the same rule applies: it's her day. Your job is to make it easier, not to be the center of it.

If You're Attending

- [ ] **Let her be the center of attention.** This isn't the day to compete for it, even in a small way.
- [ ] **Handle logistics quietly.** Parking, gifts to the car, wrangling family, so she doesn't have to think about it.
- [ ] **Stay reachable** in case she needs an easy out, without hovering.
- [ ] **If it's a co-ed shower, actually engage.** Don't disappear into a corner with the other dads all afternoon.

If You're Hosting or Co-Hosting

- [ ] **Confirm the setup and cleanup crew** ahead of time. Don't leave it to be figured out that morning.
- [ ] **Handle food and dietary restrictions** in advance, not as a last-minute scramble.
- [ ] **Have a plan for gift-opening logistics.** Someone tracks who gave what, so thank-yous aren't a guessing game later.

> **Ask her what she actually wants.** Traditions vary by family. Some showers are couples' events, some are women-only, some skip the party altogether. Follow her lead, not a template.

AFTER THE SHOWER

The follow-through is where most guys quietly disappear. Don't.

- [ ] **Help write and send thank-you notes** within two weeks. This is not solely her job.
- [ ] **Handle returns and exchanges.** Don't let duplicate onesies pile up in a closet for months.
- [ ] **Wash and organize the new baby gear** before it's actually needed, not the week the baby's due.
- [ ] **Update your prep checklist** based on what's now covered, and what still isn't.

Your Actual Job at the Baby Shower

- [ ] **Be present, not performative.** Put the phone down and actually be part of the day.
- [ ] **Follow through after.** Thank-yous and returns are your job too, not just hers.
- [ ] **Handle logistics** so she doesn't have to think about them.
- [ ] **Show up for the day she wants,** not the version that's easiest for you.

The shower is one afternoon. Everything after it (labor, the hospital stay, the first weeks home) is what **the Dudela Prep Kit** actually walks through: six pillars, nine printable tools, real founder stories.

Real Talk from John & Mike

Neither of us knew what to do with ourselves at our own baby showers. Standing around, unsure whether to help or get out of the way, is a normal way to feel. The dads who showed up best weren't the ones who took over the party. They were the ones quietly running errands, keeping an eye on her energy, and writing thank-you notes two weeks later without being asked twice. That's the whole job. It's not complicated, it's just easy to skip.

John & Mike, Dudela